

NORTH CANTERBURY ATHLETIC CLUB

CHILDRENS MANAGER 2023/24 REPORT

As this marks my final report to the North Canterbury Athletic Club committee as Manager, I want to express my heartfelt gratitude to each of you for the unwavering support. It has been a privilege being involved at this level making change for the better.

The 2023/24 season has probably been the highlight of my 3 to 4 years operating with the increased athlete numbers, increased support from families, new coaching input & the support from the senior member families. Seeing our singlet as a majority club has been amazing.

We commenced the Track & Field season with the usual open training days & this saw in total about 40 new families come & have a go. For us difficulties existed with a lack of coaching commitment, but with help from parents & committee members we saw about 30 new athletes register. Amongst these were siblings of returning athletes.

The NCAN Information Booklet was handed out to over 40 families. The content continues to save many questions. The booklet can now be updated & readied for next October. I have the template software in Power Point. It is a cost of about \$500 to print & can be funded by the WDC.

Athlete registration was slow through the first few interclub trial days. Explaining this process with clarity to new families is so important for many reasons. It is a complicated message to deliver. Communication in this first month is extremely important. We had just two families leave in the first month due to family circumstances, both reported being happy with the club.

Implementing a team environment amongst athletes & their families was a driver this season to affect family buy in to the philosophy of athlete development rather than win at all cost & also voluntarism. This assisted with our interclub duty obligations but did not alleviate all the pressures of family voluntary involvement. A messenger group was set up. An excellent way to communicate & following the chatter helped new families feel included in the conversation.

With increased numbers we were able to have all athletes, with some exceptions, involved in relay teams. We fielded full NCAN teams & on rare occasion 'fill in' athletes from other clubs were required. Families do need early communication if their athlete is involved to allow them to plan to be on time, this is a must. Again family buy in is important & celebrating the kids names via a facebook post seemed to help. Implementing a relay manager (Greg Lyon) saw the first hour chaos minimised.

With 53 registered athletes, CCAA now considered NCAN the 4th largest club behind PTOCH, SELW & CHAV.

Early season saw the moving out of long time head coach & mentor, Jo Van Rensburg & her husband Chris. Over the years both had formed important relationships with the NCAN athletic community & shall be missed. Our loss is Nelson's gain. On behalf of the club & contributing members we organised a \$660 gift voucher & trophy for Jo, a token of our appreciation for many years of service.

The addition of Laura Langley has been an important & necessary part to the success equation of the season. Although first apprehensive to the task she dedicated herself to each & every athlete. Quickly coming up to speed in terms of training regime & the levels of athlete within the crew. She has added to the team in spirit & talent. She is a relevant coach that inspires our kids, is very well liked amongst athletes & parents. It's been nice to see our NCAN families supporting her in her own events.

The first milestone event. Colgate Games – as reported (attached)

Michael Sharapoff is a guest coach who committed to one training session post Colgate Games. He came with one caveat to only train our older athletes. Being inspired by blowing out his calf muscle during a high jump session he returned & returned & returned again. I'm happy to say he has indicated returning next season with initiatives to teach parents fundamental training techniques. I suggest he & Laura team up to ensure consistency in training. I will stay in touch with Michael.

Interclub duty obligation

This remains a difficult item to manage with some families committing more than others. I would say that this season has been one of the better seasons. It would be great to find an App to manage the swaps between families. Looking at our records senior families conducted 3-4 duty sessions while new families had to do 2. We had one family who remained defiant & declined to help at the shot put. They managed to help once at the relay transition. This one family caused an ongoing duty issues & if we learn one thing from this is the message that all must help was not loud enough.

The second milestone event, Canterbury Champs, saw many PBs from our athletes. We fielded 42 athletes at this event. A large portion of our member families were all involved in the duty obligation helping most to experience their kids events. The weekend went smoothly but as per usual a long weekend. NCAN finalised the weekend & season with a dinner out at Cobb n Co in Papanui seating over 50 NCAN's.

A review of the NCAN club records & the achievements, our 2023/24 athletes have broken 23 club records, 3 being 4x 100m relay records. Some of the team's results have been amazing & each athlete should be proud of their efforts & development.

We look forward to celebrating athlete achievements at our annual Prize Giving event Saturday 30 March. We introduce new awards, a Sportsmanship award (Girl & Boy) acknowledging contribution to team spirit & the Rising Star Trophy 7-9s acknowledging achievements of an athlete within these grades. We also acknowledge runner up athletes within the awards.

Next track season:

To assist the manager, I recommend duties could be separated into the following:

- Funding – I'm happy to help with funding applications (not chocolate)
- Apparel orders
- Social Media Facebook updates
- Coaching – Laura can probably do this
- Member registration
- Interclub Duty obligations
- CCAA delegate – I can continue to do this
- Relay manager (along with Laura)

Finally I'd like to thank the Rangiora New Life School for use of the grounds, our 2023/24 funding partners contributing to club finances, Bocky Boo, The Rangiora Lions Club, The Waimakariri District Council & NJJarchitecture.

In summary a fantastic season.

Much appreciated

Nikora Jonathan

2023/24 Childrens Manager